Lesson 01: Listening and Speaking: 25 Things to Do in Berlin

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): 1.1: Listening and Speaking- 25 Things to do in Berlin; 1.2: Vocabulary Review.

In this lesson

You will watch a short travel video about Berlin. You will listen first for the main idea and then for details. You will also learn more than 20 words and phrases for describing places, and use them to talk about places you know.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Understand the main idea and important details of a short travel video.
- Name six places or activities in Berlin and say what people do there.
- Use new words for places, such as memorial and green escape.
- Say the genre, audience and purpose of a video.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
memorial	something that honors people who died, or helps us remember an event	The wall stands as a memorial to freedom.
graffiti	pictures or words painted or drawn on a wall or building	It's covered in art and graffiti.
symbol of unity	a thing that reminds us of the connection between groups of people (opposite: symbol of division)	a symbol of unity between East and West Germany
dates back to	was made at a certain time in the past	This gate dates back to the 18th century.
green escape	a quiet place in nature, with no city noise or pollution	It's a nice quiet green escape from the city.
hangout	a place where people spend a lot of time	Mauer Park is a hipster hangout.
flea market	a market, usually outdoors, for old and used things	the Mauer Park flea market
neighborhood	a part of a town or city	the Friedrichshain neighborhood

Rules and explanations

Listening for the main idea and for details

- **Main idea:** the general topic. The first time you watch, do not try to understand every word. Listen for the names of the places.
- **Details:** exact facts, such as dates, names, and things you can buy or do. Watch again and listen for these.
- **Notes:** write short words, not full sentences, like the book's notes for Mauer Park: *hipster hangout, BBQ, listening to music, flea market, old vinyls, clothes*.

Genre, audience and purpose

- **Genre:** what kind of text or video is it? (a YouTube video, a magazine article, a news program...)
- **Audience:** who will want to watch it?
- **Purpose:** why did the creators make it?

Practice

1. Before you watch. Answer aloud. Tell your tutor, or record yourself with your phone and listen back.

- Have you ever visited Berlin? Where is it?
- What do you know about this city?
- What is the Berlin Wall? Why is it an important historical landmark?

2. Vocabulary. The book uses pictures. (a) Match *old vinyls, hipster, deer* to these descriptions: 1) a young woman in a fedora hat, with lots of jewelry and trendy clothes; 2) a large wild animal with long thin legs and brown fur; 3) old records. (b) The book shows four photos: a music festival in a park, a path through a park, the Berlin Wall, and Currywurst with french fries. For each, tell your tutor what you see, why people go there, and what they can do there.

3. Listen for the main idea. Watch the video (link below). Number the six places or activities from 1 to 6 in the order you hear them. Then watch again and take notes on new words.

- Mauer Park (a music festival in a park): **4** (example)
- Tiergarten (a path through a park): ____
- East Side Gallery (the Berlin Wall): ____
- Eat Currywurst (Currywurst and french fries): ____
- Brandenburg Gate: ____
- Friedrichshain (a building covered in graffiti): ____

4. Listen for detail. Watch again and choose the correct answer.

1. What is painted on the wall? (the wall is covered in white paint / graffiti / a map of Germany)
2. When was the Brandenburg Gate built? (in 1989 / in the 18th century / 1800)

3. Why is the Hotel Adlon well known (famous)? (They serve Currywurst in the restaurant. / It was the king's hunting grounds. / Michael Jackson held his baby over a balcony.)
4. What was Tiergarten park in the past? (a hipster hangout / the King's hunting grounds / a flea market)
5. What can you buy at the Mauer Park flea market? (vinyls and clothes / graffiti / Currywurst)
6. What is there to do in the Friedrichshain neighborhood? (drink coffee / see street art / visit art galleries / all of the above)
7. True or False: The people who live in Berlin like eating Currywurst.

5. After you watch. Choose the best answer. Explain your choice to your tutor.

1. What is the genre of this video? (a video from YouTube / a magazine article / a news program / a talk show)
2. Who is the most likely audience? (young children in school / young people who like to travel / teachers / retired people)
3. What is the purpose of this video? (to tell people about interesting places to visit in Berlin / to gossip about Michael Jackson and his baby / to teach people about the food in Berlin)

6. Vocabulary review 1: definitions. Cover the Key language table. Match each word to a definition in its group.

- A. *memorial, graffiti:* a) pictures or words painted or drawn on a wall b) something that honors people who died, or reminds us of an event in which many people died
- B. *symbol of unity, dangle, infamous, dates back to:* a) made at a certain time in the past b) well known for being bad c) something that reminds us of the connection between groups of people d) to hang down loosely and swing
- C. *green escape, wild, deer:* a) living in nature without human control b) a quiet place in nature, with no city, noise or pollution c) a large wild animal with long thin legs, brown fur, and antlers if male
- D. *hangout, vintage, old vinyls, flea market:* a) an outdoor market for old and used goods b) records c) a place where a person spends a lot of time d) not new, but valued for its good condition or attractive design
- E. *street art, to spot, neighborhood, art galleries:* a) a section of a town or city b) to see or notice c) graffiti d) rooms or buildings where people look at paintings
- F. *exude, a cool vibe:* a) a feeling that someone or something gives you b) to show a quality very clearly or strongly
- G. *curry powder, sausage, concoction:* a) spicy ground meat in a narrow tube of skin b) something made by mixing different things c) a mixture of spices from Indian cooking that gives food a hot flavor

7. Vocabulary review 2. Practice with the Quizlet flashcards: https://quizlet.com/471274740/unit-1-people-and-places-25-things-to-do-in-berlin-flash-cards/

8. Vocabulary review 3. Complete the sentences. Spell the words correctly.

A. *vintage, vinyls, flea market, art galleries, hangout, exudes, to spot, neighborhood, wild deer, symbol*

1. I like to shop at the _____ because it's easy to find cheap clothes, shoes and furniture.
2. We went to Hollywood, and we tried _____ celebrities.
3. I live in a quiet _____ with lots of pretty houses.
4. I like to go to _____ to look at the paintings.
5. The US American flag is an important _____ of freedom.
6. The princess _____ elegance and confidence.
7. Sometimes people like to hunt _____.
8. Some people think the mall is a fun _____ spot.
9. I like to wear _____ clothing. I think old-style clothing is cool.
10. We used to have lots of old _____ and a record player, but now we have a CD player.

B. *vibe, curry powder, concoction, sausage, dangling, memorial, graffiti, infamous, dates back to, green escape*

1. I'm getting a bad _____ from these people. I don't like the feeling I have around them.
2. I don't eat _____. I'm a vegetarian.
3. Our dessert last night was a peanut butter and chocolate _____. It looked like a strange mixture.
4. I eat a lot of _____. I love spicy foods!
5. The Berlin Wall is a _____ that helps us remember the Cold War.
6. The Berlin Wall is covered in colorful _____, or street art.
7. Hitler was _____. He was famous for doing very bad things.
8. Michael Jackson is infamous for _____ his baby out of a window in a hotel in Berlin.
9. The Washington Monument _____ the 1840s.
10. Central Park is a nice quiet _____ from the busyness and pollution of New York City.

Speak with your tutor

- "Ask me which places in the Berlin video I would like to visit and why. Then ask me how they are similar to or different from places in my city or home country."
- "I will describe six places in Berlin, one sentence each. Correct my mistakes."
- "You are a tourist in my city. Ask me what you can do there. I will use words like neighborhood, hangout and green escape."
- "Quiz me: say a definition from this lesson, and I will say the word."

Read aloud

1. me·MO·ri·al
2. graf·FI·ti

3. NEIGH·bor·hood
4. con·COC·tion
5. ex·UDE
6. Have you ever visited Berlin? (↗)
7. What do you know about this city? (↘)
8. This gate dates back to the 18th century. (↘)

Watch online

- 25 Things to do in Berlin (travel video): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lw5NHQeXzpA

Answer key

1. (example answer) Berlin is in Germany. The Berlin Wall divided East and West Berlin. It came down in 1989, so it is an important historical landmark.
2. (a) hipster 1, deer 2, old vinyls 3. (b) (example answer) In the park I see a crowd and a stage. People go there to listen to music and relax.
3. East Side Gallery 1, Brandenburg Gate 2, Tiergarten 3, Mauer Park 4 (book), Friedrichshain 5, Eat Currywurst 6. Only number 4 is given in the book, so check the others in the video.
4. (book) 1 graffiti; 2 in the 18th century; 3 Michael Jackson held his baby over a balcony; 4 the King's hunting grounds; 5 vinyls and clothes; 6 all of the above; 7 True.
5. 1 a video from YouTube; 2 young people who like to travel; 3 to tell people about interesting places to visit in Berlin.
6. (book) A: memorial b, graffiti a. B: symbol of unity c, dangle d, infamous b, dates back to a. C: green escape b, wild a, deer c. D: hangout c, vintage d, old vinyls b, flea market a. E: street art c, to spot b, neighborhood a, art galleries d. F: exude b, a cool vibe a. G: curry powder c, sausage a, concoction b.
7. No key.
8. (book) A: 1 flea market; 2 to spot; 3 neighborhood; 4 art galleries; 5 symbol; 6 exudes; 7 wild deer; 8 hangout; 9 vintage; 10 vinyls. B: 1 vibe; 2 sausage; 3 concoction; 4 curry powder; 5 memorial; 6 graffiti; 7 infamous; 8 dangling; 9 dates back to; 10 green escape.

My notes